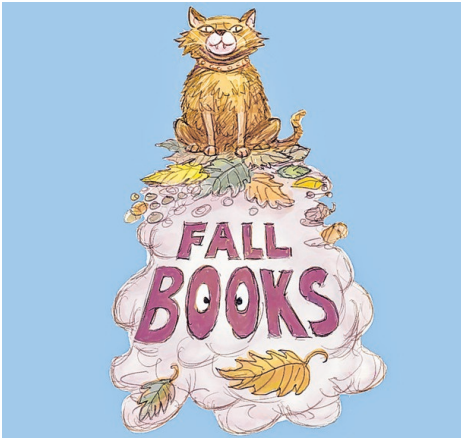




WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Trump has summoned** Fed governor Lisa Cook to appear before a committee he has formed to evaluate mortgage-fraud allegations against her, signaling a renewed effort to fire her and wield more control over the central bank. **A1**
- ◆ **A Nvidia-backed** cloud-computing company scrapped plans for Australia's largest IPO in almost 30 years, a new sign that investors are growing leery of lofty valuations for AI-related companies. **B9**
- ◆ **Chinese automaker Geely** plans to begin selling vehicles in Canada next year. **B9**
- ◆ **Porsche car deliveries** fell 16% in the first nine months of the year. **B9**
- ◆ **German regulators fined** VW \$1.3 million, saying it failed to disclose potentially market-moving news in a proper and timely manner. **B9**
- ◆ **The typical American** family got a little wealthier in the years following the Covid-19 pandemic, while well-off and older Americans got much richer. **A2**
- ◆ **As bond yields rise**, small companies are taking the brunt of the damage, with the Russell 2000 index falling for a fifth-straight week. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq each rose 0.6%, and the Dow gained 0.8% on Friday. **B10**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Trump said** his administration reached a deal for Russia to supply diesel fuel, a major policy shift that eases U.S. pressure on Moscow over its war with Ukraine in hopes of lowering domestic fuel prices ahead of the midterms. **A1**
- ◆ **A growing group** of Republicans is privately and publicly sounding the alarm that the party will perform poorly in next month's contests. **A1**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** has charged more than 60 people as noncitizen voters in the past few months, but election experts and defense lawyers said the push confirms the crime is rare. **A4**
- ◆ **Prediction market Kalshi** has launched a probe into a series of suspicious trades about the selection of Trump's new press secretary. **A4**
- ◆ **Houthi militants** are taking aim at Saudi Arabia's air links to the world, rattling travelers and squeezing another key sector of the kingdom's economy. **A7**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** announced sanctions on the International Criminal Court, threatening to dismantle it over an arrest warrant for Israeli leader Netanyahu. **A8**
- ◆ **The Nobel Peace Prize** was awarded to South African human-rights lawyer and judge Navi Pillay. **A8**
- ◆ **Died: Mike Ditka**, 86, NFL legend as player, coach. **A14**

PEGGY NOONAN
Sam Altman no
Oppenheimer. **A13**

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Dangerous Hurricane Isaia Lashes Gulf Coast



WILD WINDS: An umbrella was no help in Pensacola Beach as Isaia bore down Friday on the Gulf Coast. The first hurricane of the Atlantic season crashed ashore later as a Category 2 storm, making landfall later near Destin on the Florida Panhandle. **A3**

President Rushes to Turn Out Base to Boost GOP in Midterms

President Trump huddled with an unconventional adviser on Air Force One last week as he traveled to a rally in Mobile, Ala.: far-right activist Laura Loomer.

As Loomer offered the president campaign advice—attack “jihadist candidates,” she told him—she had a bigger worry in the back of her mind. The playbook that returned Trump to the White House

two years ago might not work in this year's midterms.

“A lot of these candidates are not very dynamic people, and the president’s rallies are a last-ditch effort to bring them across the finish line,” she said. “It’s just very difficult to inspire people to get out to vote when you have a lot of do-nothing candidates who are not necessarily as dynamic as the president.”

Trump, she said, was “positive” but “realistic” about the GOP’s prospects.

Loomer is part of a growing group of Republicans who are privately and publicly sounding the alarm that the party will perform poorly in next

month’s contests. Strategists and advisers are describing 2026 as one of the most difficult political environments for an incumbent party in recent memory. Republicans are confronting higher prices, Trump’s war with Iran and the lowest approval rating of

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◆ **Prosecution of noncitizen voting cases ramps up... A4**

U.S. Says Deal Is Set For Diesel Shipments From Russia

President Trump said Friday his administration reached an agreement for Russia to supply hundreds of thousands of tons of diesel fuel, marking a major policy shift that eases U.S. pressure on Moscow over its war with Ukraine in hopes of lowering domestic fuel prices ahead of the midterm elections.

By Brian Schwartz, Benoit Morenne and Thomas Grove

The move, which included suspending sanctions on Russian diesel exports for six months, comes as Trump and fellow Republicans are struggling to address voter worries over diesel and gasoline prices.

In a post on Truth Social, Trump wrote Russia would immediately supply over 300,000 tons of diesel fuel into the U.S. and global markets, an additional 500,000 tons in November, and 1 million “immediately thereafter.”

He said Russia would later deliver an additional 3 million tons of diesel “within a short period of time,” based on the condition of its refineries. Some refineries are offline in the Middle East and Russia, and the world is short about 1.6 million barrels of diesel a day, the International Energy Agency said last month.

The new supplies, if they

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INSIDE

EXCHANGE
More valuable than gold: The hunt for AI computing power is upending Silicon Valley. **B1**

WORLD NEWS
The Nobel Peace Prize goes to South Africa’s Navi Pillay, for her work promoting international law. **A8**

Top Chefs Have a Confession: They Love Taco Bell

* * *

The chain may be a polarizing brand, but these chefs love the ‘Live Más’ lifestyle

By ADAM CHANDLER

In life’s grand pursuit of perfect bites, the whole chicken at Cafe Commerce in New York City makes a strong bid.

The \$99 dish, roasted with herb butter under the skin, comes with crunchy sourdough stuffing infused with foie gras and mashed potatoes whipped with butter.

Its creator, chef Harold Moore, who counts a Michelin star among his many honors, likens the harmony of his ingredients to another near-flawless dish: the Crunchy Supreme taco from Taco Bell.

“There is everything in the perfect bite,” Moore said of the vaunted marriage of ground beef, shredded cheese, iceberg lettuce, tomatoes and rich sour cream in a corn shell. “It’s hot, it’s cold, it’s crispy, it’s also supple.

There’s spice, but then it has sour cream that calms it. It’s a very complete experience.”

The “Live Más” lifestyle gets más love from chefs.

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Crunch time

Robot Push Proves Tricky for Walmart

Machines sorting merchandise hit kinks with some products; ‘peak complexity’

By SARAH NASSAUER

Walmart has relied for years on more than 140,000 warehouse workers to unload trucks, forklift pallets of merchandise into warehouses, sort and store the goods on towering racks, then reverse the entire flow to send them out to stores and homes.

It isn’t an easy job. A worker might walk 20,000 steps a shift. It also isn’t all that complicated—unless you try to program robots to do it.

Consider the seemingly simple task called “break-pack”—removing items from cardboard boxes to send out individually. It’s a no-brainer for Walmart’s humans. But it turned into one of the many challenges bedeviling the company’s decadelong, multi-billion-dollar quest to automate its warehouses.

Walmart and the robotics

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New Italian Job’s Loot: \$5.6 Million in Wine

ROME—Thieves stole thousands of bottles of wine worth about \$5.6 million from a vineyard in Tuscany in one of the largest, most audacious wine heists in recent history.

By Margherita Stancati, Nick Kostov and Laura Cooper

Marchesi Antinori, one of Italy’s most renowned winemakers, said on Friday that 30,000 bottles of some of its most prized wine varieties were stolen.

Seven masked people entered an Antinori warehouse in the Tuscan town of Cortona during the first weekend in October and loaded two large trucks with the bottles, which had been packed and assembled in preparation for being shipped to foreign markets, said Renzo Cotarella, the company’s chief executive.

The thieves turned off the alarm, forced open a gate and used the vineyard’s own forklifts to lift the wine crates and load them into the trucks, Cotarella said. Company workers discovered the theft on Oct. 5, when the shipments were supposed to be transported, the CEO said.

The company was caught off guard: Antinori had never experienced a robbery, Cotarella said. The bottles weren’t insured.

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